

KRYSTYNA MIKAVA

User Experience & Digital Product Designer

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PROFILE

UX/Digital Product Designer with 1+ year of practice in UX, Human-Computer Interaction, and accessible interface design gained through 10+ completed projects and real-world professional experience. My multidisciplinary background spans frontend development, graphic design, content design, and digital marketing, allowing me to create user-centred solutions that are both technically feasible and visually effective, while collaborating confidently across cross-functional teams. Passionate about continuous learning and emerging technology, I have developed practical experience using AI as a research and design-assistance tool through professional, independent, and academic projects. This also includes an AI-focused MSc dissertation at Trinity College Dublin, which was selected for mentorship with IBM Design.

EXPERIENCE

Interface & Interaction Design Lead | UX Designer

May – Sept 2026

MODU - Home Planning & Furniture-Assembly Gamified App (Accessibility Focus), replacing classic manuals. Graduate capstone project, Trinity College Dublin; now being explored for commercialization.

- Mapped the complete user flow and information architecture; created 40+ low-fidelity wireframes, followed by another 40+ high-fidelity variations involving 4 iteration rounds to refine design according to user-testing feedback.
- Conducted research, involving academic, into the usability failures of traditional furniture-assembly manuals, identifying core comprehension and accessibility gaps that shaped an interaction model built around neurodivergent user needs.
- Validated the app's real-world usefulness through moderated in-person testing with 25+ participants, including neurodivergent users (ADHD, ASD, dyslexia, dyspraxia) and neurotypical testers during dedicated user-testing sessions and public showcase. 100% rated it more useful than a traditional manual, and 90% completed tasks with no navigation or usability issues.
- Defined personalization features across UI and interaction design, letting users tailor guidance and pacing to individual cognitive needs.
- Embedded WCAG accessibility compliance across the full product lifecycle (from information architecture and user-flow mapping to UI and frontend implementation) by translating cognitive-accessibility research into developer-ready design specifications.
- Bridged design and engineering as the team's design-to-frontend contributor, collaborating with other code developers, 2D/3D artists, and marketing/branding to align design decisions with technical and commercial constraints ahead of public launch.

Brand & Visual Designer | Marketing Strategist & Audience Researcher Intern

May – Aug 2025

Faculty of Science and Engineering (FSE), Maynooth University

- Established a consistent digital identity for the Faculty by designing FSE's logo and a full suite of reusable social media templates in Adobe Photoshop and Canva, adopted across 20+ recurring event campaigns.
- Shaped FSE's content and platform strategy by benchmarking 5+ leading STEM institutions (Trinity, UCD, TUD, MIT, Cambridge) and conducting audience research across 6 target segments.
- Enabled a full year of consistent, ready-to-publish content by building a 12-month LinkedIn/Instagram content calendar with captions, visual direction, and format guidance for 20+ Faculty events.

Event & Portrait Photographer - Independent

2024 – Present

- Built an independent photography practice delivering portrait, urban, and exhibition photography, and event documentation.

Digital & Print Media Designer | Research Assistant – SPUR Intern

May – Oct 2024

"Under the Feet of Shadows" Multimedia Project. MART Gallery & Maynooth Media Dept.

- Contributed to a multimedia collaboration with digital media artist EL Putnam and writer Mike McCormack that reached international audiences through exhibitions at MART Gallery, Dublin, and CIACLA Contemporary Irish Arts Center, Los Angeles.

- Designed the full suite of print and digital promotional assets — posters, postcards, booklets, advertisements — in Illustrator, Photoshop, and InDesign, plus After Effects motion graphics integrated into the installation.
- Documented production and installation through photography and social media video production. Supported research, production, and exhibition installation activities throughout the project lifecycle.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Artsy Dublin (*March 2026*) — Web platform concept for discovering Dublin's local arts and performance events, with personalized recommendations and lightweight social event-buddy finding.

Blizzard Countdown (*Dec 2025*) — Interactive, gamified narrative built in Twine SugarCube, exploring how interface design and user decision-making shape a complex interactive story.

More projects here: [portfolio website](#)

SKILLS

UX/UI Design: Figma, Balsamiq, Webflow, Useberry; information architecture (IA); user scenarios, personas & flows; user testing & cross-device testing; visual (clickable wireframes) & coded (frontend) prototyping; accessible design (WCAG); Miro.

AI-Assisted Design: Claude (Design & Code), Google Gemini, ChatGPT, Copilot, Higgsfield.ai, Loveart — for ideation, research synthesis, assisting in prototyping, visual & textual content.

Visual & Motion Design: Adobe Creative Suite (Illustrator, Photoshop, After Effects, InDesign, Express); Blender.

Web Development: proficient in HTML, CSS, GitHub, code WCAG, Wix, Webflow; foundations in React.js, JavaScript, p5.js, database organization.

Other: Teamwork & leadership, presentation design and storytelling, digital law & GDPR, fast independent learning.

EDUCATION

MSc Interactive Digital Media — Distinction (1:1)

2025 – Sept 2026

Trinity College Dublin

Focus: UX/UI/HCI design, frontend & foundations of backend, still & moving graphic design, interactive storytelling.

Dissertation (*selected for mentorship by IBM Design*): "The Synthetic (AI) Brand Personas — from Practice of Ethical Creation & Integration to Exploration of Audience Perception & Implications for Brand." Combined iterative, node-based AI prompt-writing to produce complex visuals with in-depth human-perception research.

BA Media Studies — Distinction (1:1)

2022 – 2025

Maynooth University

Gold Muse Award 2025 for Outstanding Media Design Undergraduate Project.

LANGUAGES

English: Full professional proficiency

Russian / Ukrainian: Native speaker

Other: Basic understanding of Slavic (Belarusian, Polish) and Caucasian (Georgian, Mingrelian) languages